Northwind Labs - Sales Employee Handbook

Sample - fictional company. All names, policies, and figures are invented for demonstration purposes.

Effective October 1, 2026. Maintained by Human Resources (Sophia Martinez, Head of HR).

1. Welcome and Purpose

Welcome to the Sales department at Northwind Labs. Sales acquires and grows Northwind Labs' global enterprise client relationships across all three product lines.

This handbook covers policies specific to Sales employees. The department is led by Claire Sterling (Head of Sales). Where this handbook and a company-wide policy differ, this handbook applies to Sales employees.

2. Work Hours and Offices

The Sales team's standard hours are 8:30 AM to 5:30 PM local office time, Monday through Friday. Account executives may adjust their hours to match client time zones with their manager's approval.

Northwind Labs has three offices. Office hours and office contacts are:

Office	Hours	Office contact	Email
New York	Mon-Fri 9:00 AM - 5:00 PM EST	Marcus Cole	ny-office@northwind.example
London	Mon-Fri 8:30 AM - 4:30 PM GMT	Fiona Gallagher	london-office@northwind.example
Austin	Mon-Fri 8:00 AM - 5:00 PM CST	Travis Reed	austin-office@northwind.example

3. Remote and Hybrid Work

Sales employees may work remotely up to 2 days per week. Mondays are in-office for the weekly pipeline review. Client-site days count as in-office days.

4. Paid Time Off

Sales employees accrue 18 days of paid time off (PTO) per year. PTO may not be scheduled during the last 10 business days of a fiscal quarter without approval from the Head of Sales. Up to 3 unused PTO days may be carried over into the next calendar year.

Sick leave is separate from PTO: every employee receives 8 paid sick days per year. A doctor's note is required only for absences longer than 3 consecutive work days.

Parental leave is 16 weeks fully paid for the primary caregiver and 8 weeks fully paid for the secondary caregiver.

5. Company Holidays and Closures

The following company holidays and closures apply to all departments for the 2026-2027 season:

Date	Holiday	Status

Thursday, November 26, 2026	Thanksgiving Day	All offices closed
Friday, November 27, 2026	Day after Thanksgiving	All offices closed
Thursday, December 24, 2026	Christmas Eve	Modified hours - offices close at 1:00 PM
Friday, December 25, 2026	Christmas Day	All offices closed
Friday, January 1, 2027	New Year's Day	All offices closed

Employees required to work on a company holiday receive a substitute day off, to be taken within 90 days.

6. Commissions, Travel, and Client Entertainment

Commissions are paid monthly, on the 15th of the month following the month in which the deal closes and the customer's first payment is received.

Account executives earn a 10% commission on first-year contract value. Renewals earn a 4% commission.

The client entertainment limit is $150 per client attendee per event. Any single event above $1,000 total requires pre-approval from the Head of Sales.

Air travel under 6 hours must be booked in economy class. Flights of 6 hours or more may be booked in premium economy.

Expense reports must be submitted within 30 days of the expense, with itemized receipts for anything over $25.

The Sales kickoff offsite is on Friday, December 4, 2026. The sales floor is closed that day and the whole team attends the offsite.

7. Equipment and Allowances

Each Sales employee receives a laptop and a company mobile phone. A monthly phone and internet allowance of $75 is paid with regular payroll.

8. Training and Development

New Sales hires complete a 4-week onboarding bootcamp. The Client Pitch Workshop, an advanced solution-selling training session, is held on Wednesdays.

9. Benefits Enrollment

Open enrollment for health benefits runs from November 2 to November 20, 2026. New hires must enroll within 30 days of their start date.

Northwind Labs matches 401(k) contributions dollar-for-dollar up to 5% of salary. Employees are eligible for the match after 90 days of employment.

10. Conduct and Reporting Concerns

Concerns about harassment, discrimination, or safety can be reported to your manager, to Human Resources, or anonymously through the Northwind Labs ethics hotline. Retaliation against anyone who reports a concern in good faith is prohibited.

Questions about corporate governance, regulatory compliance, or contracts go to the Legal department, led by Rachel Vance (Head of Legal).

11. Who to Contact

Sales policy questions: Claire Sterling (Head of Sales).

Pay, benefits, and leave: Human Resources - Sophia Martinez (Head of HR).

Laptops, accounts, and access: the IT Help Desk.

Badges, physical security, and workplace safety incidents: Security - Nathan Brooks (Director of Security).